

and manufacturing to installation and maintenance. Besides telecommunications, demand from defence and education sectors is also driving growth of general-purpose test equipment sales.

The Indian general-purpose test equipment market comprises electronic counters, network analysers, logic analysers, spectrum analysers, oscilloscopes, multimeters, LCR metres, power metres, signal generators, function generators, arbitrary waveform generators, digital pattern generators and protocol analysers. It had earned revenues of over Rs 4346 million in 2007, which are estimated to touch Rs 6692 million in 2011.

Network downtime losses more than double since 2003

India Inc. lost Rs 432 billion in 2008-09 due to high occurrence of power outages, scheduled as well as non-scheduled—says a joint study by Manufacturers' Association for Information Technology (MAIT) and Emerson Network Power (India). The amount of such direct losses has more than doubled since 2003 when these amounted to Rs 220 billion.

With significant companies relying on IT infrastructure for automation, productivity and business management, employee productivity and customer management were severely impacted by such downtime. Among the various verticals studied, the manufacturing sector was the most adversely hit.

The study mapped the impact of network downtime in about 800 firms across seven industrial centres, namely, Mumbai, Delhi, Bengaluru, Chennai, Kolkata, Hyderabad and Pune. Detailed information on downtime experiences, typical causes and solutions adopted, reactions to uptime, etc was sought from senior executives across fourteen major industry verticals including manufacturing, electronics, telecom, IT services, IT-enabled services, banking and finance, pharmaceutical, biotechnology, SMEs, retail, hotels, real estate,



(R) Moon B. Shin, managing director, and (L) R. Manikandan, business group marketing head-business solutions, LG Electronics India, at the launch of LG's business products

infrastructure and hospitality.

Import of mobile handsets without IMEI banned

The Indian government has banned the import of all mobile handsets that do not support the international mobile equipment identity (IMEI) number. The use of mobile phones without proper IMEI numbers is now seen by the government as a threat to the country's security, as terrorists have been found to use mobile phones extensively. The ban may hit a number of Chinese and Taiwanese manufacturers that were flooding India with cheap handsets via the grey market.

IMEI is a 15-digit code unique to every GSM, WCDMA and iDEN mobile phone, as well as some satellite phones. It is usually found printed inside the battery compartment of the phone. Fake address submission and no IMEI display are becoming favourite error tools to perform anti-national and anti-social activities. The IMEI number is used by the GSM network to identify valid devices and therefore can be used to stop a stolen phone from accessing the network.

BSNL setting up WiMax stations in Orissa

Bharat Sanchar Nigam Ltd (BSNL) will soon set up six WiMax (wireless broadband) stations at its Berhampur telecom district. The Berhampur telecom district covers the Ganjam and Gajapati districts in south Orissa. The equipment have already been provided for installation of the WiMax stations and the stations are expected to become operational during the current year.

The WiMax stations would be set up at Mohana and Kasinagar in Gajapati district as well as Digapahandi, Buguda, Jagannath Prasad and Polasara in Ganjam district.

LG rechristens IT division as business solutions

LG Electronics India has broadened its portfolio in the IT hardware segment and is heading towards becoming a leader in the B2B market with the launch of high-tech business products.

After achieving sustained market leadership in monitors and optical drives in India, LG is taking complete business solutions approach by offer-